

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Central Asian political field

TIMURID FRAGMENTS -> competing princes and unstable coalitions

UZBEKS / SHAIBANI -> pressure and consolidation in Transoxiana

SAFAVIDS / SHAH ISMAIL -> temporary opening after Merv, 1510

OTTOMANS / CHALDIRAN, 1514 -> regional balance shifts indirectly

BABUR -> Farghana and Samarqand claimant searching for a durable base

RULE: regional geopolitics constrained agency; it did not cause Panipat alone.

MUST REMEMBER: Babur's route runs from Farghana (1494) through Kabul (1504) to Panipat, Khanwa and Ghagra (1526-29).

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Babur chronology 1494-1530

1494 Farghana -> 1497 / 1501 Samarqand captures and losses

1504 Kabul -> 1510 Merv opening -> 1514 Chaldiran context

1519-20 Bhira and Sialkot -> November 1525 final march

1526 Panipat -> 1527 Khanwa -> 1528 Chanderi -> 1529 Ghagra

30 December 1530 -> Babur dies at Agra

MEMORY: Central Asian constraint -> Indian opening -> staged consolidation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Layered identity and legitimacy

PATERNAL -> Timurid descent and sovereign prestige

MATERNAL -> Chagatai / Chingizid association

MILITARY-POLITICAL -> Turco-Mongol practices and mobile cavalry world

CULTURAL -> Persianate court culture + Chagatai Turkish literary expression

INDIAN DYNASTIC LABEL -> Mughal

TRAP: identity explains legitimacy and networks, not biological destiny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Samarqand cycle: prestige versus resources

SAMARQAND -> Timurid legitimacy + affluent strategic centre

CAPTURE -> symbolic success

SUPPLY + MONEY + HINTERLAND + FOLLOWER LOYALTY -> insufficient

UZBEK PRESSURE + unstable coalitions -> repeated loss

LEARNING -> manoeuvre, resource discipline and limits of city possession

OUTCOME -> Central Asian failure redirects rather than predestines policy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Kabul-Qandahar strategic bridge

KABUL 1504 -> survival base, recruitment and southward platform

QANDAHAR -> rear security and Iranian-Central Asian interface

KABUL -> routes toward Kashgar, China, Transoxiana and Turkistan

QANDAHAR -> routes toward Khurasan, Iran and West Asia

LIMIT -> route potential did not automatically solve fiscal weakness

BRIDGE -> Indian agrarian resources + north-western security and trade.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Punjab and the Lodi opening

BABUR'S EARLIER PUNJAB MOVES + TIMURID CLAIMS

|

IBRAHIM LODI-NOBLE TENSIONS + DAULAT KHAN + ALAM KHAN

|

local opening, information and favourable timing

|

BABUR EXPANDS BEYOND THE INVITERS' LIMITED PURPOSE

FORMULA: external push + internal opening + converting agency.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Final march and Panipat frontage

NOVEMBER 1525 -> Babur leaves Kabul after securing rear and flank

- > Punjab movement and communication control
- > narrow prepared frontage at Panipat
- > carts linked by raw-hide ropes + breastworks + firing positions
- > gaps retained for cavalry action

TRAP: not a straight unprepared ride from Kabul to one battle.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Panipat combined-arms system

FIRE -> artillery and matchlockmen under Ustad Ali and Mustafa

FIX -> carts, ropes, breastworks and constrained frontage

MOVE -> mounted archery, cavalry gaps and tulghuma flanking

COMMAND -> sequencing, reserve use and battlefield coordination

CONTEXT -> Ibrahim's organisation and deployment also matter

VERDICT: guns were important inside a system, never a solitary miracle.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: After Panipat: decision to stay

PANIPAT -> Delhi-Agra centre opens

BUT -> forts resist + Afghans remain + begs dislike India + supplies strain

BABUR DISTRIBUTES WEALTH + appeals to followers + chooses settlement

INDIAN RESOURCES -> support a new political base

RESULT -> invasion begins to become state formation

LIMIT -> Humayun and the Sur interregnum expose continuing fragility.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Panipat-Khanwa-Ghagra ladder

PANIPAT 1526 -> Ibrahim Lodi -> removes the Delhi sultanate centre

KHANWA 1527 -> Rana Sanga coalition -> checks a rival north Indian alignment

CHANDERI 1528 -> bounded follow-through against a Rajput stronghold

GHAGRA 1529 -> eastern Afghan resistance in a Bengal-linked setting

TACTICS may recur; opponents, theatres and political functions change

TRAP: consolidation was staged, not complete in April 1526.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Central Asian constraint, Indian political openings and Babur's choices together explain conquest and settlement.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Baburnama and heritage source method

BABURNAMA -> Chagatai Turkish first-person chronology and observation

STRENGTH -> routes, places, campaigns, gardens and ruler perception

LIMIT -> selective memory, self-fashioning, rhetoric and number inflation

BAGH-E BABUR -> tomb, terraces, water works and layered later interventions

UNESCO -> archaeology, documents, images and conservation reconstruction

RULE: material heritage can corroborate context, not every memoir claim.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: The Baburnama is unusually proximate first-person evidence, but self-fashioning and transmission limit neutrality.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 12 answer spine

OPEN -> Central Asian failure made India attractive, not inevitable

PUSH -> Timurid fragmentation + Uzbek pressure + Kabul resource limits

OPENING -> Punjab claims + Lodi fissures + invitations

MECHANISM -> prepared combined arms and Babur's command

CONSOLIDATION -> decision to stay + Panipat-Khanwa-Ghagra ladder

CLOSE -> a real but fragile Mughal foundation joined two strategic worlds.